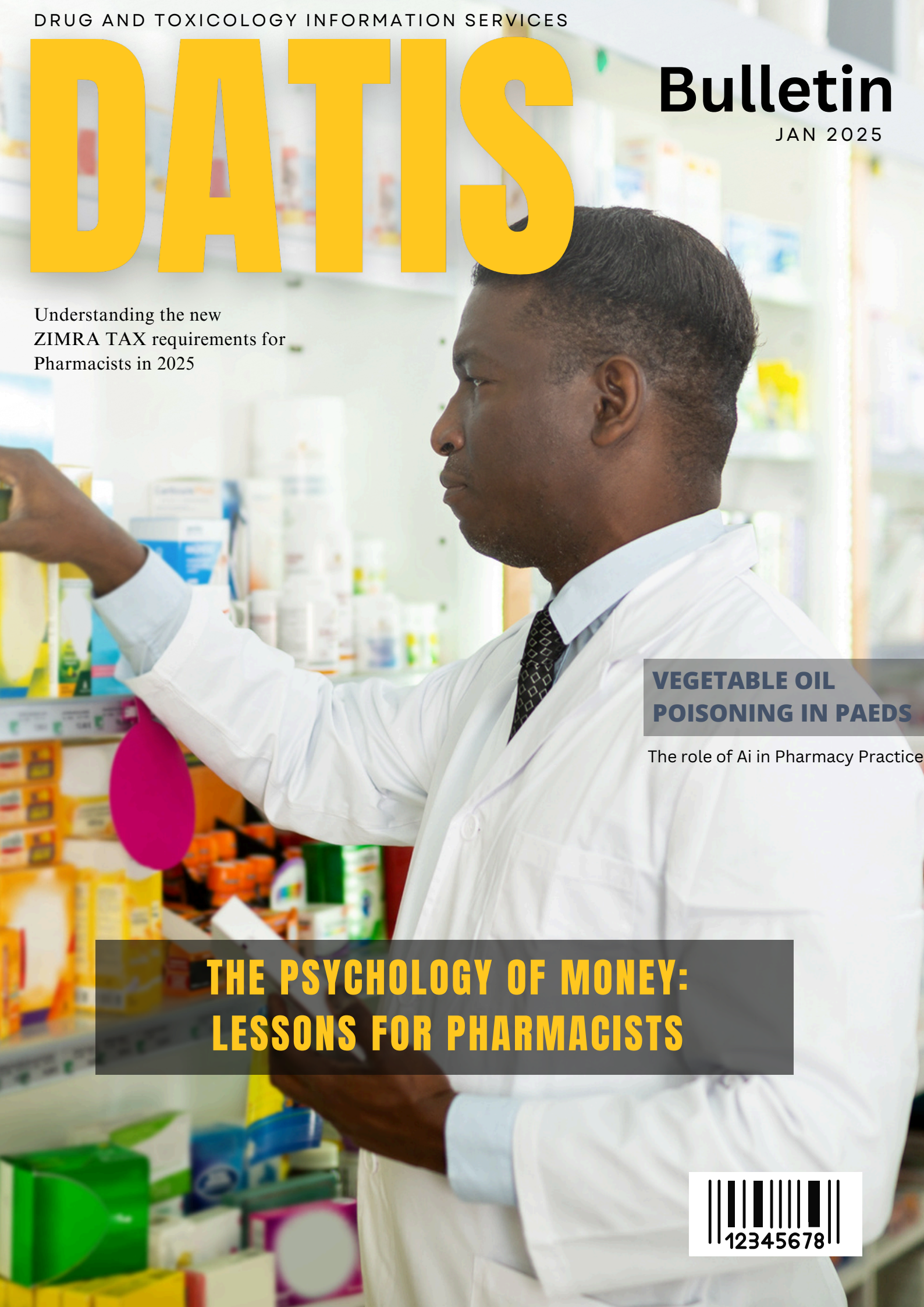
DRUG AND TOXICOLOGY INFORMATION SERVICES

DATIS Bulletin

JAN 2025



Understanding the new ZIMRA TAX requirements for Pharmacists in 2025

VEGETABLE OIL POISONING IN PAEDS

The role of Ai in Pharmacy Practice

THE PSYCHOLOGY OF MONEY: LESSONS FOR PHARMACISTS

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Vegetable Oil Poisoning in Pediatrics: A Misguided Remedy for Baby Colic

Colic, characterized by excessive and inconsolable crying in infants, is a distressing condition that often drives caregivers to seek unconventional remedies. In some cases, vegetable oils (such as castor oil or coconut oil) are improperly administered orally or applied topically as a traditional treatment for colic. While these oils are widely used in households, their inappropriate use in pediatric care raises significant safety concerns.

Understanding Vegetable Oil Poisoning

Vegetable oils, though generally safe when used appropriately in cooking or skin moisturization, can pose serious risks when misused, especially in infants. These risks arise from:

1. Aspiration Risk

Administering oils orally can lead to aspiration, as babies have an immature swallowing reflex. Aspiration of oil into the lungs can result in lipoid pneumonia, a rare but severe condition that requires immediate medical attention. Symptoms include coughing, difficulty breathing, and persistent respiratory distress.

2. Digestive Overload

Infants' gastrointestinal systems are immature and cannot process large quantities of oil. Ingestion may lead to diarrhea, vomiting, and abdominal pain, exacerbating the colic symptoms rather than alleviating them.

3. Allergic Reactions

Certain vegetable oils may trigger allergic reactions in sensitive infants, leading to skin irritation, gastrointestinal discomfort, or respiratory issues.

4. Toxicity Concerns

While rare, some oils (like castor oil) contain compounds that can act as irritants or toxins in large amounts. Castor oil, for instance, has a laxative effect and can cause dehydration in infants.

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Evidence-Based Alternatives for Colic Management

The management of colic in infants should focus on evidence-based approaches rather than unverified remedies. Safe and effective strategies include:

1. Parental Soothing Techniques

- Rocking, swaddling, or gently massaging the baby can provide comfort.
- White noise or soft music may help calm the infant.

2. Feeding Adjustments

- Ensure proper latching during breastfeeding to reduce air intake.
- Burp the baby after feeding to release trapped gas.

3. Medication

- Simethicone drops may reduce gas buildup in some infants.
- Probiotics like Lactobacillus reuteri have shown potential benefits in reducing colic symptoms (Sung et al., 2013).

4. Medical Consultation

Persistent colic symptoms should be evaluated by a pediatrician to rule out underlying conditions like gastroesophageal reflux disease (GERD) or milk protein allergy.

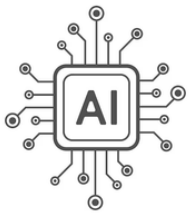
Public Health Education

Raising awareness about the risks associated with unproven remedies like vegetable oil for colic is critical. Caregivers should be encouraged to consult healthcare professionals before trying alternative treatments. Community education programs can dispel myths and promote safer practices in pediatric care.

Conclusion

While vegetable oils may seem like harmless home remedies, their misuse in treating baby colic can lead to severe complications, including poisoning and respiratory distress. Parents and caregivers must prioritize evidence-based treatments and seek professional guidance to ensure the safety and well-being of their infants.

THE ROLE OF AI IN PHARMACY PRACTICE



Artificial intelligence (AI) is rapidly transforming industries worldwide, and pharmacy practice is no exception. As the healthcare landscape becomes increasingly complex, AI offers innovative solutions to optimize pharmaceutical services, improve patient outcomes, and enhance operational efficiency. Its integration into pharmacy practice is reshaping the way pharmacists deliver care, making processes smarter, faster, and more patient-centered.

One of the most significant contributions of AI in pharmacy practice is its ability to personalize patient care. By analyzing large datasets that include patient demographics, genetic information, medical history, and lifestyle habits, AI-powered tools can recommend individualized treatment plans. This level of precision is particularly valuable in pharmacogenomics, where algorithms predict how a patient might respond to specific medications. This reduces the likelihood of adverse drug reactions and ensures that patients receive therapies tailored to their unique needs.

Inventory management, a critical aspect of pharmacy operations, has also been revolutionized by AI. Predictive analytics tools help pharmacies maintain optimal stock levels by forecasting demand based on historical sales data, seasonal trends, and real-time local health statistics. This minimizes wastage, ensures the availability of essential medications, and prevents stockouts that could jeopardize patient care. With AI, pharmacies can achieve a balance between cost-effectiveness and excellent service delivery.

Medication adherence remains one of the most persistent challenges in healthcare, with many patients failing to take their medications as prescribed. AI-based solutions, such as chatbots and mobile applications, have emerged as valuable tools in addressing this issue. These technologies send automated reminders, track medication schedules, and provide real-time feedback to patients. By engaging patients and encouraging adherence, AI-driven tools contribute to better therapeutic outcomes and reduced healthcare costs.

Another critical area where AI is making strides is drug discovery and development. Traditional drug development processes are time-consuming and expensive, often taking years to bring a new medication to market. AI accelerates this process by analyzing massive datasets to identify potential drug candidates, predict efficacy, and assess safety profiles. Machine learning models can simulate drug interactions and toxicity levels, helping researchers focus their efforts on the most promising compounds. This innovation is particularly crucial in addressing urgent health crises and developing treatments for rare diseases.

In the pharmacy setting, AI streamlines administrative tasks that often consume valuable time. By automating prescription processing, insurance claims, and documentation, AI allows pharmacists to dedicate more attention to patient care. Virtual assistants and voice recognition software further enhance efficiency by simplifying workflows. As a result, pharmacists can focus on providing personalized consultations, answering patient queries, and offering clinical expertise.

AI also plays a vital role in enhancing clinical decision support. Integrated systems analyze patient data to identify potential drug interactions, contraindications, and dosage errors. These systems provide pharmacists with actionable insights, enabling them to make safer and more informed decisions. By reducing the risk of medication errors, AI enhances the overall safety and quality of pharmaceutical care.

Despite its many advantages, the integration of AI into pharmacy practice is not without challenges. Concerns about data privacy and security must be addressed to ensure patient information remains confidential. Additionally, there is a need for clear regulatory frameworks to govern the use of AI in healthcare. Over-reliance on technology may also pose risks, highlighting the importance of human oversight in critical decision-making processes. Pharmacists must acquire new skills to effectively collaborate with AI tools and harness their full potential.

As AI continues to evolve, its applications in pharmacy practice will expand, offering even greater opportunities to transform the profession. By embracing this technological revolution, pharmacists can enhance their roles as healthcare providers, delivering smarter, safer, and more effective care. The future of pharmacy lies in the synergy between human expertise and artificial intelligence, working together to improve health outcomes and advance the profession.

The Psychology of Money: Lessons for Pharmacists



Morgan Housel's The Psychology of Money explores the emotional and psychological factors influencing how people think about and manage money. For pharmacists—whether community practitioners, wholesalers, or entrepreneurs—the lessons in this book can offer profound insights into financial decision-making, long-term planning, and achieving professional and personal financial well-being. Below are key takeaways adapted for pharmacists.

1. Wealth Is What You Don't See

Housel emphasizes that true wealth is the ability to live below your means and save, rather than flaunting material possessions.
• Application for Pharmacists:
Many pharmacists fall into the trap of upgrading their lifestyles as their incomes grow—luxury cars, expensive gadgets, and frequent vacations. However, wealth accumulation lies in saving and investing wisely.
• Live below your means and channel excess income into investments like property, stocks, or expanding your business.
• For business owners, reinvest profits into upgrading pharmacy operations or diversifying revenue streams rather than focusing solely on visible status symbols.

2. The Power of Compounding

Housel highlights the importance of patience and time in building wealth. He explains that small, consistent actions over time create exponential growth.
• Application for Pharmacists:
• Personal Finances: Start early with savings and investments, even if the amounts are small. Compounding interest works wonders over time. For example, invest in low-cost mutual funds or retirement plans.
• Business Growth: Consistently reinvest in your pharmacy to improve infrastructure, staff training, and digital tools. Over time, these incremental improvements will compound to enhance profitability and competitiveness.

3. Save, Not Just to Spend, but for Flexibility

Housel argues that saving isn't just about spending later—it's about creating flexibility and freedom in life.
• Application for Pharmacists:
• As a pharmacist, emergencies can arise—a business slump, unforeseen medical expenses, or regulatory changes. An emergency fund equivalent to at least 6–12 months of expenses can provide stability during uncertain times.
• Use savings to give yourself the freedom to innovate or explore opportunities, such as starting a new pharmacy branch or investing in new services like telehealth.

4. Control Your Time

Housel emphasizes that the ultimate goal of financial independence is to control your time and decisions.
• Application for Pharmacists:
• Many pharmacists work long hours in stressful environments. Prioritize building financial security so you can work fewer hours or focus on projects that truly matter to you, such as improving community health or mentoring young pharmacists.
• Entrepreneurs in pharmacy should aim to delegate routine tasks by training staff, freeing time for strategic planning and personal growth.

5. Risk and Luck Go Hand in Hand

Housel argues that success often involves a combination of risk-taking and luck, and that recognizing this balance can prevent overconfidence or despair.
• Application for Pharmacists:
• Taking Risks: Opening a pharmacy or starting a wholesale business involves significant risk. Accept that not every decision will lead to success, but calculated risks can lead to significant rewards.
• Recognizing Luck: If your pharmacy is doing well, acknowledge external factors like timing, location, or market conditions that contributed. Stay humble and continue adapting to avoid complacency.

The Psychology of Money: Lessons for Pharmacists

6. Be Financially Resilient

Housel stresses the importance of resilience—being prepared for the unexpected and staying afloat when things go wrong.
- Application for Pharmacists:
- Diversify your income streams: Offer additional services (e.g., point-of-care testing, wellness consultations) or invest in other businesses to reduce dependence on a single source of revenue.
- Manage debt cautiously: Avoid over-leveraging your pharmacy business with loans for unnecessary expansions or upgrades. Instead, ensure that debt aligns with growth and profitability goals.

7. Avoid the Seduction of Greed

Housel cautions against the trap of always wanting "more," as this often leads to poor financial decisions.
- Application for Pharmacists:
- Set clear financial goals for your career and business. For instance, decide how much income or profit is "enough" to meet your needs and long-term aspirations, rather than chasing endless growth at the expense of health or relationships.
- Celebrate small wins, like hitting savings targets, paying off debt, or expanding services, rather than continually moving the goalposts.

8. Tailor Your Financial Strategy to Your Personality

Housel advises that there is no one-size-fits-all approach to money. Your financial decisions should align with your values, goals, and risk tolerance.
- Application for Pharmacists:
- If you're risk-averse, focus on stable investments like bonds or established businesses. If you're entrepreneurial, you might explore riskier ventures like opening multiple pharmacies or launching innovative products.
- Align your strategy with your vision of success—whether it's retiring early, expanding access to healthcare, or funding your children's education.

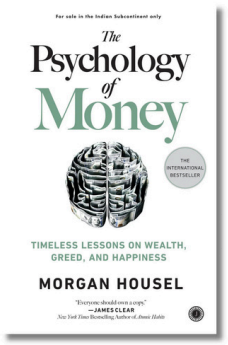
9. Avoid Comparing Yourself to Others

Housel explains that comparing your financial journey to others leads to dissatisfaction and poor decisions.
- Application for Pharmacists:
- Your pharmacy might not generate as much revenue as others, or you might not own as many properties as your peers. Focus on your unique goals and circumstances instead of trying to match others' achievements.
- Recognize that everyone has different challenges, opportunities, and definitions of success. Stay true to your values and progress at your own pace.

10. Know When Enough Is Enough

Housel's key message is to define what "enough" means to you and resist the urge to endlessly pursue more wealth or success.
- Application for Pharmacists:
- Decide when your pharmacy business has reached a sustainable and fulfilling level of growth. Expanding endlessly might dilute quality, increase stress, or create financial strain.
- Balance professional success with personal well-being—take time for family, hobbies, and community involvement.

By applying Morgan Housel's principles from The Psychology of Money, you can develop healthier financial habits, make informed decisions, and build sustainable businesses. Whether it's saving for emergencies, taking calculated risks, or knowing when to stop chasing more, these lessons offer a roadmap for financial success and personal fulfillment in the pharmacy profession.





Revolutionizing Community Pharmacy Operations: Harnessing the Power of Digital technology

As we step into 2025, the pharmaceutical industry faces increasing pressure to deliver efficient, patient-centered services while maintaining profitability. Community pharmacies, often the backbone of primary healthcare, are not exempt from this challenge. To thrive in this dynamic landscape, leveraging technology is no longer optional—it's a necessity. Enter OrderingBook and OrderExpress, two game-changing platforms designed to transform pharmacy operations.

What are OrderingBook and OrderExpress?

· **OrderingBook:** A digital assistant that streamlines online ordering and logistics for pharmaceutical products. With features such as real-time inventory tracking, supplier comparisons, and automated reordering, it eliminates the guesswork from stock management.

· **OrderExpress**: A platform enabling pharmacies to place urgent orders with rapid turnaround times. It's tailored for situations where speed is critical, ensuring pharmacies can meet patient demands without delay.

Why Community Pharmacies Should Embrace These Platforms

1. Enhanced Inventory Management

One of the most significant pain points for community pharmacies is stockouts and overstocking. OrderingBook leverages predictive analytics to forecast demand based on historical data, seasonal trends, and real-time sales. This ensures that your shelves are stocked with what patients need, when they need it, without tying up capital in excess inventory.

2. Cost Savings

By comparing suppliers' prices and delivery times through OrderingBook, pharmacies can make data-driven purchasing decisions. OrderExpress complements this by offering competitive rates for urgent orders, reducing the financial burden of emergency restocking.

3. Improved Operational Efficiency

Automation is the cornerstone of efficiency. With OrderingBook, pharmacists can automate routine tasks like placing orders and tracking deliveries, freeing up time to focus on patient care. The integration of OrderExpress ensures that even unforeseen supply chain disruptions are managed seamlessly.

4. Better Customer Experience

Patients expect reliability. Stockouts or delays in medication availability can tarnish a pharmacy's reputation. By leveraging these platforms, pharmacies can maintain consistent service levels, fostering trust and loyalty among customers.

5. Scalability and Growth

As your pharmacy grows, so do its operational complexities. OrderingBook and OrderExpress are scalable solutions that adapt to your business needs, making it easier to expand services or manage multiple locations.

A Real-World Example

Imagine this: A pharmacy in Harare has seen an uptick in demand for cold and flu medications due to a seasonal outbreak. Traditionally, this would lead to frantic calls to suppliers, delayed shipments, and patient dissatisfaction. With OrderingBook, the pharmacy identifies the demand spike early, adjusts orders accordingly, and replenishes stocks efficiently. In cases where the surge exceeds predictions, OrderExpress steps in to deliver emergency supplies within hours. The result? Happy customers and a pharmacy that's always one step ahead.

The days of manual order tracking and reactive stock management are over. By adopting OrderingBook and OrderExpress, community pharmacies can not only survive but thrive in the modern healthcare ecosystem. These platforms empower pharmacies to operate smarter, reduce costs, and deliver exceptional patient care.

Elitech temperature data loggers are widely used in pharmacies to monitor and record temperature and humidity levels, ensuring proper storage conditions for temperature-sensitive products such as vaccines, medicines, and other pharmaceuticals. These data loggers are essential for maintaining compliance with Good Distribution Practices (GDP) and ensuring product safety.

Features of Elitech Temperature Data Loggers for Pharmacies

1. Accuracy: High-precision sensors for reliable temperature and humidity monitoring.
2. Real-Time Monitoring: Some models provide real-time data transmission via Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, or GSM.
3. Data Storage: Can store a large number of records, ensuring no data is lost during operations.
4. Customizable Alerts: Alarms for deviations from preset temperature ranges.
5. Compliance: Compliant with WHO, CDC, and FDA regulations for cold chain monitoring.
6. Portability: Compact and portable, making them suitable for both storage areas and transport monitoring.
7. Battery Life: Long battery life for uninterrupted data collection.
8. Reporting: Easy data retrieval with USB connection or cloud-based software for generating detailed reports.

Popular Models for Pharmacies

- Elitech RC-5/RC-5+: Affordable and user-friendly USB temperature data loggers.
- Elitech RC-61: Waterproof design suitable for vaccine storage.
- Elitech GSP-6: High-capacity logger with a built-in display for real-time temperature and humidity reading.
- Elitech Temtop Series: Advanced models offering wireless connectivity and cloud integration.

Benefits for Pharmacies

- Ensures compliance with regulatory standards.
- Prevents spoilage and ensures the integrity of temperature-sensitive products.
- Provides detailed records for audits and quality assurance.
- Alerts staff in case of temperature excursions, reducing risks.

"RELIABLE TEMPERATURE MONITORING FOR PHARMACIES."



ZIMRA TAX Unpacked

New ZIMRA Requirements for Pharmacists

Unpacking the New ZIMRA Requirements for Pharmacists

The Zimbabwe Revenue Authority (ZIMRA) has recently introduced amendments under Section 80A of the Income Tax Act [Chapter 23:06], which mandate the submission of a valid Tax Clearance Certificate (TCC) for professional registration and licensing across various professions, including pharmacists. These requirements are part of ZIMRA's drive to enhance compliance and streamline tax administration. Here's what pharmacists need to know about these changes and how to navigate them efficiently.

What is a Tax Clearance Certificate (TCC)?

A Tax Clearance Certificate is an official document issued by ZIMRA to confirm that a taxpayer is compliant with tax obligations. The certificate shows that the individual or entity has filed all required tax returns and paid any outstanding taxes.

Why is a TCC Now Required for Pharmacists?

The new policy applies to health practitioners, including pharmacists, registered under the Health Professions Act [Chapter 27:19]. The aim is to ensure that all practicing professionals are tax compliant at the time of registration, renewal, or certification with the Health Professions Authority (HPA) or relevant professional councils.

This requirement aligns with broader efforts by ZIMRA to formalize professional sectors and curb tax evasion.

When Should the TCC be Submitted?

Pharmacists must provide a valid TCC at two key points:
1. During Registration: If you are a new pharmacist registering with HPA or another professional body for the first time.
2. At Renewal: When renewing your professional license.

The TCC must be valid and issued no earlier than 30 days prior to submission to the licensing body.

Steps to Obtain a TCC
1. Registration on the ZIMRA Platform: Pharmacists must register for a Business Partner Number (BPN) via the ZIMRA Self-Service Portal (SSP) at mytaxes.zimra.co.zw.
2. Submission of Tax Returns: Ensure that all required tax returns (Income Tax, VAT, and PAYE, if applicable) have been filed.
3. Payment of Outstanding Taxes: Settle any tax arrears or negotiate a payment plan with ZIMRA.
4. Application for the TCC: Once compliant, apply for the TCC through the SSP.

Consequences of Non-Compliance

Failure to submit a valid TCC can lead to:
- Rejection of registration or license renewal applications.
- Suspension of professional practice rights.
- Additional penalties and interest on outstanding tax obligations.

Additional Notes for Pharmacists
1. Collaborate with Your Employer: If you are employed, confirm with your employer that they are compliant with PAYE and VAT remittances, as this can affect your individual tax status.
2. Plan Ahead: Apply for your TCC well before your registration or renewal deadline to avoid delays.
3. Consult a Tax Expert: If you encounter challenges, seek assistance from a qualified tax consultant or contact ZIMRA directly via their contact center.

Continuous Professional Development

Workshop for Pharmacists



Venue	Zoom Meetings
Date	18 January 2025
Time	1200 - 1300 Hrs
	(GMT +2Hrs)

Tawanda Joseph Mwedzi

Bsc (Hons) in Applied Accounting (Oxford Brookes), ACCA Advanced Diploma in Accounting& Business, ACCA Accounts and Tax Consultant at Freotek Consultancy



TOPIC

"Tax Clearance in the pharmacy profession - What you need to know"

Attendance is open for all! Each meeting will award the Pharmacist a total of 5 points for a fee.

Contact/Call

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COPENHAGEN 2025
FIP WORLD CONGRESS
31 August - 3 September



FIP WORLD CONGRESS

FIP world congress 2025, themed "**Pharmacy Forward: Performance, Collaboration, and Health Transformation,**" aims to explore the evolving role of the pharmacy profession in the context of modern healthcare challenges. The congress will explore how pharmacists can drive forward the performance of healthcare systems, foster meaningful collaboration across sectors, and catalyse transformative changes in health outcomes globally. The congress is structured around three subthemes, each addressing key facets of this overarching theme.

The subtheme "**Making it sustainable"** focuses on enhancing global health through sustainable resource use, innovative health solutions, and robust policy frameworks. It addresses key challenges like supply chain efficiency and antimicrobial resistance while emphasising preventive care and digital health. It also highlights the importance of professional development, aiming to integrate sustainability into pharmacy education and practice, thereby reinforcing the profession's global health impact.

For more information
https://copenhagen2025.fip.org/

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JANUARY ZOOM MEETING

Presenter:
Tawanda Joseph Mwedzi
Bsc (Hons) In Applied Accounting - Oxford Brookes University, Uk
ACCA Advanced Diploma in Accounting and Business
Accounts And Tax Consultant at Freotek Consultancy

Topic:
Bookkeeping and Tax Clearance in the pharmacy profession - What you need to know.

Date: Saturday 18 January 2015



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